ALPHIRA CAPITAL

CRYPTO FUTURES & SPOT TRADING

3-Month Professional Course Curriculum

Foundation to advanced application

COURSE PROFILE	ALPHIRA CAPITAL
Duration	3 months | 12 teaching weeks | 60 lessons | 20 modules
Level	Beginner foundation to advanced applied study
Markets	BTC, ETH and selected liquid altcoins | Spot, dated futures and perpetuals
Core tools	Charts, dominance indices, order books, volume profile, VWAP, funding, OI, basis, on-chain dashboards and trading journals
Training format	Concept sessions, chart practice, replay, paper trading and assessed projects

Course objective

Build a structured approach to crypto market analysis, instrument selection, spot portfolio management, futures execution and risk control.

Learning outcomes

Analyse market context; build spot and futures plans; size exposure; manage risk; validate setups; maintain a trading journal.

Month 1: Foundations and technical structure - Lessons 1-20.
Month 2: Market analysis, spot and futures mechanics - Lessons 21-40.
Month 3: Derivatives analysis, execution and assessment - Lessons 41-60.

CONTEXT > INSTRUMENT > STRUCTURE > LIQUIDITY > RISK > EXECUTION > REVIEW

Curriculum edition 1.2 | October 2026

MONTH 1 | FOUNDATION

Market foundations

MODULE 01 - CRYPTO MARKET ARCHITECTURE

Lessons 1-3 | Shared foundation

- Blockchain, consensus, nodes, miners and validators
- Coins, tokens, stablecoins and wrapped assets
- Wallets, private keys, custody and settlement
- Layer-1, Layer-2, bridges and oracles
- CEX, DEX, OTC and fragmented price discovery
- Trading pairs, quote currencies and transfer security

MODULE 02 - CEX, DEX AND MARKET PARTICIPANTS

Lessons 4-6 | Shared foundation

- CEX vs DEX: custody, access, execution and costs
- Order-book, AMM and hybrid venue models
- Liquidity pools, price impact, slippage and MEV
- Retail, institutions, holders, issuers and OTC desks
- Market makers, liquidity providers and arbitrageurs
- Maker/taker activity, inventory and spread management
- Venue due diligence and counterparty risk

MODULE 03 - SPOT, FUTURES AND PERPETUALS

Lessons 7-9 | Shared foundation

- Spot vs Futures vs Perpetuals
- Asset ownership vs contractual exposure
- Dated contracts, expiry, settlement and rolling
- Linear, inverse and coin/stablecoin-settled contracts
- Contract size, tick size and lot size
- Long/short exposure and P&L calculations
- Last price, index price and mark price

MONTH 1 | FOUNDATION

Market context and cycles

MODULE 04 - BTC DOMINANCE AND USDT DOMINANCE

Lessons 10-12 | Shared foundation

- BTC dominance: calculation and chart analysis
- USDT dominance: calculation and chart analysis
- BTC price vs BTC.D scenarios
- Stablecoin supply, depegs and denominator effects
- ETH/BTC and relative market leadership
- Dominance limitations and confirmation filters

MODULE 05 - TOTAL, TOTAL2, TOTAL3 AND BTC INFLUENCE

Lessons 13-15 | Shared foundation

- Total Crypto Market Cap and circulating supply
- TOTAL2 & TOTAL3: composition and analysis
- Stablecoin-excluded market-cap indices
- Market breadth, concentration and relative strength
- BTC influence on altcoins
- Correlation, beta, rotation and stress transmission
- ALT/USD vs ALT/BTC and scenario planning

MODULE 06 - CRYPTO MARKET CYCLES AND REGIMES

Lessons 16-18 | Shared foundation

- Crypto market cycles and macro liquidity
- Bull / Bear / Accumulation / Distribution
- Markup, markdown and regime transitions
- Trend vs range across timeframes
- Range tests, springs, upthrusts and failed breakouts
- Acceptance, rejection and confirmation
- Regime-based strategy selection and no-trade filters

MONTHS 1-2 | SHARED ANALYSIS

Structure, liquidity and research

MODULE 07 - TECHNICAL ANALYSIS AND MARKET STRUCTURE

Lessons 19-21 | Shared analysis

- HH, HL, LH, LL; breaks and failed breaks
- Support/resistance, candles and chart patterns
- Multi-timeframe analysis and confluence
- Moving averages, RSI, ATR and VWAP
- Volume profile, value areas and trade invalidation

MODULE 08 - ORDER BOOKS, LIQUIDITY AND ORDER FLOW

Lessons 22-24 | Shared analysis

- Bid/ask, spread, depth and matching mechanics
- Market/limit orders, partial fills and slippage
- Resting liquidity, sweeps and absorption
- Delta, CVD, footprint and spot vs futures flow
- Heatmaps, hidden liquidity and data limitations

MODULE 09 - BTC, ETH AND ALTCOIN ANALYSIS

Lessons 25-27 | Shared analysis

- BTC structure, spot participation and event risk
- ETH/USD, ETH/BTC and ecosystem context
- Altcoin screening, sectors and liquidity filters
- Relative strength, correlation and watchlists
- Asset-specific scenarios and thesis invalidation

MODULE 10 - ON-CHAIN AND FUNDAMENTAL CONTEXT

Lessons 28-30 | Shared analysis

- Token utility, supply, emissions, vesting and unlocks
- Market cap vs fully diluted valuation
- Addresses, transactions, fees and exchange flows
- TVL, protocol revenue and token-holder economics
- Catalysts, governance, audits and protocol risks

MONTH 2 | SEPARATE TRACKS

Spot management and futures mechanics

MODULE 11 - SPOT TRADING EXECUTION

Lessons 31-33 | SPOT TRACK

- Tactical spot trades vs long-term allocations
- Market, limit, stop-market, stop-limit and OCO orders
- Staged entries, partial exits and full exits
- Trend pullback, breakout-retest and range reclaim
- Custody, wallet security and transfer checks
- Fees, balance reconciliation and trade records

MODULE 12 - SPOT PORTFOLIO AND CAPITAL PROTECTION

Lessons 34-36 | SPOT TRACK

- Core/tactical allocation and reserve policy
- Position sizing and investment exposure caps
- Token, sector, venue and custody concentration
- Correlation, stress testing and drawdown control
- Stablecoin and liquidity risk
- Rebalancing and portfolio performance review

MODULE 13 - LEVERAGE, MARGIN AND LIQUIDATION

Lessons 37-39 | FUTURES TRACK

- Notional exposure and effective leverage
- Initial margin vs maintenance margin
- Isolated vs cross margin and auto-add settings
- Collateral haircuts and coin-collateral risk
- Liquidation thresholds, fees and margin buffers
- Insurance funds and auto-deleveraging
- Stop placement before liquidation and stress scenarios

MONTHS 2-3 | FUTURES TRACK

Derivatives analysis and execution

MODULE 14 - FUNDING, OPEN INTEREST AND BASIS

Lessons 40-42 | FUTURES TRACK

- Funding rates, intervals, payments and carrying costs
- Open interest vs volume; contract vs USD units
- Price/OI scenarios and liquidation data
- Basis, premiums/discounts and term structure
- Contango, backwardation and annualised dated basis

MODULE 15 - FUTURES EXECUTION AND RISK CONTROL

Lessons 43-45 | FUTURES TRACK

- One-way/hedge mode; reduce-only and post-only
- Stop trigger sources and partial-fill handling
- Cost-aware position sizing and exposure limits
- Daily/weekly loss limits and drawdown pauses
- Outages, rejected orders and position reconciliation

MODULE 16 - PRACTICAL MODELS AND PLAYBOOKS

Lessons 46-48 | SPOT + FUTURES

- Trend pullback and continuation models
- Breakout, acceptance and retest models
- Liquidity sweep and range-reclaim models
- Entry, stop, target and invalidation rules
- Track-specific controls and no-trade filters

MODULE 17 - HEDGING, BASIS TRADES AND ADVANCED RISK

Lessons 49-51 | FUTURES TRACK

- Spot/futures hedges and hedge ratios
- Dated cash-and-carry and variable perpetual carry
- Financing, funding reversal and basis risk
- Interim liquidation and cross-venue margin risk
- Legging risk, partial fills and two-leg unwinds

MONTH 3 | PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE

Psychology, validation and assessment

MODULE 18 - PSYCHOLOGY AND PROFESSIONAL ROUTINE

Lessons 52-54 | Shared practice

- FOMO, revenge trading and cognitive biases
- Pre-session preparation and scenario planning
- Daily routines, readiness checks and pause rules
- Process grading vs outcome grading
- Error logs, discipline and weekly review

MODULE 19 - BACKTESTING, JOURNALING AND VALIDATION

Lessons 55-57 | Shared practice

- Fixed setup rules, data selection and cost models
- Look-ahead, survivorship and selection bias
- Development samples, holdouts and robustness
- Win rate, average R, expectancy and profit factor
- Maximum drawdown and portfolio performance
- Screenshots, execution audits and forward simulation

MODULE 20 - FINAL ASSESSMENT AND CAPSTONE

Lessons 58-60 | Assessment

- Knowledge and calculation examination
- Spot portfolio and trade-plan presentation
- Futures trade plans and order-execution drill
- Three validated playbooks and research defence
- Historical/replay and forward-simulation review
- Personal trading plan and remediation

Practical training throughout the course

Chart annotation | Venue comparisons | Risk calculations | Paper orders | Portfolio stress tests | Historical replay | Trading journals

COMPLETION FRAMEWORK

Assessment, certification and risk

Final submission

100 historical/replay trades + 20 sequential forward-simulated trades; three documented playbooks; spot and futures capstones; and a personal risk policy.

Assessment weighting

Knowledge and calculations: 25% | Spot capstone: 20% | Futures capstone: 25% | Research and journal: 20% | Process and oral defence: 10%.

Proposed pass criteria

At least 75% overall and 70% in each track capstone, plus all critical risk and execution checks. Unsafe or incomplete work requires remediation and reassessment.

Certificate of course completion

Proposed Alphira Capital educational award for Crypto Futures & Spot Trading. Issuance is subject to Alphira Capital approval. It is not a regulatory licence or external accreditation, and does not guarantee trading profitability.

Educational risk disclaimer

This programme is for education only and is not personalised financial, legal or tax advice. Cryptoassets can be highly volatile, illiquid or lose all value. Leveraged products can cause rapid losses and liquidation; depending on product terms, losses may exceed initially posted margin. Stops may slip or fail. Fees, funding, gaps and collateral movements can increase losses.

Exchange failures, hacks, custody loss, stablecoin depegs, smart-contract faults and withdrawal restrictions can cause irrecoverable loss. Historical and simulated results do not predict future performance. Use paper trading for course exercises, protect credentials, check local eligibility and only consider capital you can afford to lose. No guaranteed returns.

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